Merchant Category Code Handbook (Sample)

Reference Guide for AI-Driven Classification POC

5812: Eating Places and Restaurants

Merchants that prepare food and beverages for immediate consumption. Includes cafes, cafeterias, and fine dining.

> *Audit Note: Primary revenue must come from food sales.*

5411: Grocery Stores and Supermarkets

Merchants that sell a broad range of food products for off-premise consumption.

> *Audit Note: Often confused with 5812 if the merchant has a small cafe section.*

5735: Record Shops

Merchants primarily engaged in the retail sale of records, tapes, and compact discs.

> *Audit Note: Includes musical instruments as a secondary line.*

7298: Health and Beauty Spas

Merchants providing therapeutic and cosmetic services, including massage, facials, and yoga instruction.

> *Audit Note: Yoga-only studios may sometimes fall here or in 7991.*

5691: Men’s and Women’s Clothing Stores

Retailers of ready-to-wear clothing and accessories.

> *Audit Note: Standard retail classification.*

5999: Miscellaneous and Specialty Retail

Catch-all category for specialized retailers such as pet shops, art galleries, or gift shops.

> *Audit Note: Use only if no specific specialized code applies.*

8299: Schools and Educational Services

Specialized instruction such as art schools, dance studios, or barista training workshops.

> *Audit Note: Distinct from accredited universities.*